

The 99-Cent Question

At what point does "Bring Back the Castle" stop paying for itself?

August 2026 · model at `mtc/model_99c.py` · every figure below is computed, not assumed

THE 99 CENTS IS A DONATION TO BRING BACK ALADDIN'S CASTLE. It is not an investment in \$ACM, is not solicited as one, and confers no expectation of profit. The token grant is a membership credential with no cash value inside the system. All wallet custody, token placement and revocation terms are disclosed in the ULA.

01

The loop that closes on itself

A user pays 99¢. Apple takes its cut. From what is left we pay Solana account rent, a transfer fee, and grant the user some quantity of \$ACM as their membership credential. Everything remaining is profit, and **100% of profit buys more \$ACM** — which raises the price, which makes the next user's grant more expensive. The system funds its own cost inflation.

02

Unit economics, per download

Line	15% tier (<\$1M)	30% tier (>\$1M)
Price	\$0.9900	\$0.9900
Apple commission	-\$0.1485	-\$0.2970
Solana account rent (sunk)	-\$0.4080	-\$0.4080
Transfer fee	-\$0.0010	-\$0.0010
HEADROOM available for \$ACM	\$0.4325	\$0.2840

Rent is modelled as **non-recoverable**. It is refundable only by closing the account, which means shutting the system down — and a user who changes phones leaves a wallet we cannot reclaim. For a going concern it is a cash outlay, and **every download is a new wallet** even when it is the same human on a second device.

03

The master equation

break-even \$ACM price = headroom ÷ grant per user $\$0.4325 \div 1 \text{ token} = \0.4325 works until price rises $1,632 \times \$0.4325 \div 1,000 = \0.00043 works until price rises $1.6 \times \$0.4325 \div 10,000 = \0.00004
ALREADY UNDERWATER TODAY

At today's price of \$0.000265 the largest grant that breaks even is **1,632 \$ACM** at the 15% tier, or **1,071** at 30%.

KRW-C-2026-002's cooling machine needs roughly 10,000 \$ACM per user to move float meaningfully. The 99¢ app can fund 1,632. It pays for 16% of what cooling requires.

04

The answer

10,000,000 downloads

Every one of them profitable, at **\$0.4325** per download below the \$1M Apple threshold and **\$0.2840** above it. Total banked over the pool's life: **\$2.84M – \$4.33M**. The wall arrives not from weak demand but from the pool running dry.

Your wallet holds **11,767,037 ACM**. Releasing **10,000,000** as the funding pool and holding **1,767,037** as R&D reserve gives ten million downloads of free inventory at one token per user — every grant costs nothing, and the margin is the full headroom.

Grant per user	Downloads covered free	Then
1 ACM	10,000,000	must buy at market
10 ACM	1,000,000	must buy at market
100 ACM	100,000	must buy at market
1,000 ACM	10,000	must buy at market

05

What stops it — and it is us

Because 100% of profit buys \$ACM, by the time the pool empties at ten million downloads that buying has lifted the price from \$0.000265 to **\$18.62** — a factor of **70,266**. The next token then costs \$18.62 against \$0.2840 of headroom.

Buying \$ACM with the profits is what prices the program out of its own token. The app makes the asset valuable and is then unable to afford the thing it made valuable.

Redeployment policy	Price at pool-out	Can the program continue?
Redeploy 100% (planned)	\$18.62	No — one token costs \$18.62
Redeploy 0% (hold cash)	\$0.000265	Yes — one token costs \$0.0003

The R&D reserve is the other side of that coin: **1,767,037 ACM at \$18.62 is \$32.9M** on paper. That is a real number and an unsellable one — a \$22.7K pool cannot be exited at anything near that price, because the same $(1 + C/R)^2$ curve runs in reverse on the way out.

06

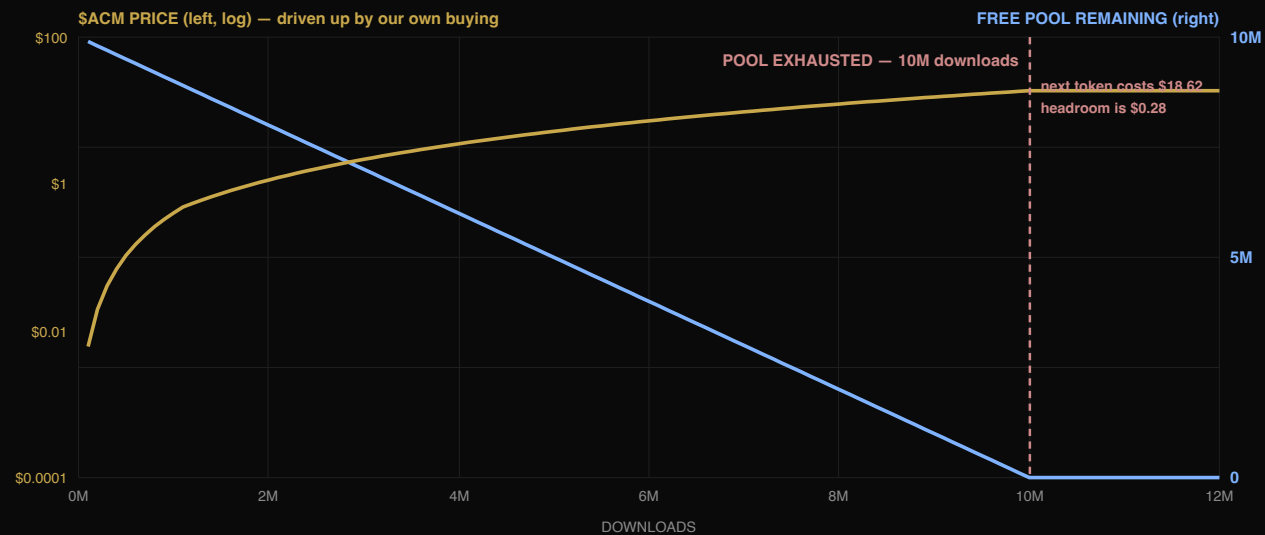
The three levers

Lever	Effect
Grant 1 token, not 1,000	10M downloads of runway instead of 10,000. The single largest factor.
Redeploy less than 100%	Keeps the token affordable so the program can continue past the pool.
Deepen the pool before launch	~\$100,000 of quote-side depth absorbs the buying instead of repricing on it.

And one that is not a lever: **rent consumes 41% of gross at every scale**. It is fixed in dollars, it is the largest cost after Apple, and it does not come back. Not minting a wallet until a user actually engages would recover more than any other change on this page.

Why the system chokes on its own success

Blue: the free pool draining, one token per download. Gold: the \$ACM price, driven up by our own redeployed profit. The program is comfortably profitable for the whole blue line — then hits a wall the gold line built.



Both axes logarithmic. Model: 1 \$ACM granted per user, 100% of profit redeployed, constant-product price impact $P'/P = (1 + C/R)^2$ per KRW-C-2026-001, quote reserve seeded at \$11,373.

READING IT

Downloads	Free pool left	\$ACM price	State
1,000,000	9,000,000	\$0.40	profitable · grant free
3,000,000	7,000,000	\$2.05	profitable · grant free
6,000,000	4,000,000	\$7.16	profitable · grant free
9,000,000	1,000,000	\$15.32	profitable · grant free
10,000,000	0	\$18.62	POOL GONE — next token \$18.62 vs \$0.28

Ten million paid downloads is an extraordinary outcome for a nostalgia app. The model says you would reach it profitably — and that the thing which finally stops you is a policy choice you control, not the market.

Read the other direction, this is a **constructive** result. Instagram drew 762 million downloads globally in 2025; ten million is a little over one percent of that, and every one of those ten million pays for itself. The binding constraint is not demand and not Apple — it is how much \$ACM leaves the pool per user, and what the profit does next. Both are yours to set.